

01

NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Do not turn curriculum discussion into proof of a metaphysical or epistemological claim.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Do not turn curriculum discussion into proof of a metaphysical or epistemological claim.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Do not turn curriculum discussion into proof of a metaphysical or epistemological claim.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not turn curriculum discussion into proof of a metaphysical or epistemological claim.

ANSWER LINE: Do not turn curriculum discussion into proof of a metaphysical or epistemological claim.

02

NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA: CORE DISTINCTIONS

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

“Nyāya (the school of logic and valid knowledge) supplies the method of warranted cognition, while Vaiśeṣika (the school of categories and atomism) supplies the realist inventory that the later synthesis explains as one liberation-oriented system.”.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Master verdict: Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika is a realist system in which a detailed ontology is disclosed through valid cognition, error is a misrelation among real factors, and liberation follows removal of false knowledge.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Not every general term names a real universal (jāti, class-universal); where a proposed jāti is blocked, Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treats it as an imposed property or limiting condition (upādhi, adjunct), not as a new padārtha. □□ Philosophical function.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika affirms Īśvara as an eternal, omniscient, omnipotent being. □ God is the nimitta-kāraṇa (efficient cause), not the material cause of the world. □ The material cause remains atoms.

ANSWER LINE: “Nyāya (the school of logic and valid knowledge) supplies the method of warranted cognition, while Vaiśeṣika (the school of categories and atomism) supplies the realist inventory that the later synthesis explains as one liberation-oriented system.”.